



STUDY GUIDE

Eastern Vocals (MUSIC)

Category Overview

This category focuses on vocal precision, control, and interpretive storytelling. Participants will have the opportunity to highlight their technical range through surr (pitch), talaffuz (diction), and tasteful improvisation across various Eastern genres.

Overview:

- Participants: Solo performances only
- Accompaniment: Live instrumentalist from team (max 2 allowed) or pre-recorded backing track
- Song choice must be from Eastern Music Genre (eg. classical, folk, qawali, ghazal etc.)
- Rounds: 3 rounds (all elimination rounds with 3rd one serving as the final round)

Round 1 – Aaghaaz (Audition Phase):

- Duration: 4 minutes
- Elimination round
- Participants perform one Eastern song of their choice (Classical, Ghazal, Folk, or Sufi).
- This round tests core vocal stability, pitch accuracy (surr), and comfort on stage.

Round 2 – Sangam (Mash-up):

- Duration: 5 minutes
- Elimination round
- Those who qualify Round 1 will perform a mashup bridging two contrasting Eastern genres or styles. This round tests dynamic range, tempo shifts, and creative vocal transitions.

Round 3 – Kamaal-e-surr (Final):

- Duration: 5 minutes
- Top finalists perform a complete Eastern piece, showcasing peak technical capability. Judges will look for complex vocal improvisations (alaaps, taans, sargam), emotional connection, and stage presence.



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Judging Criteria:

- Pitch and Accuracy (Surr) [10 points]: Precision in hitting correct notes. Smooth transitions between notes without going off-pitch.
- Vocal Expression & Vibe [10 points]: Ability to convey the core emotion of the song (e.g., soulful, romantic). Breath control, voice texture, and dynamic control (soft vs. powerful delivery)
- Improvisation & Creativity [10 points]: Tasteful vocal extensions (stylistic variations) that elevate the melody. Personal nuance added while maintaining the song's original essence.
- Stage Presence & Confidence [10 points]: Body language, posture, and connection with the audience. Comfort on stage and natural delivery under performance settings.
- Presentation & Diction [10 points]: Clear pronunciation of lyrics (Hindi/Urdu talaffuz). Microphonic technique, timing, and overall polished finish.

Note:

1. The decisions of the esteemed panel of judges will be final, binding, and uncontestable under any circumstances.
2. All song selections must feature appropriate lyrics suitable for a school environment. Any song containing explicit, offensive, or inappropriate language and themes will lead to immediate disqualification.